THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT DALLAS

800 W. Campbell Road EC-31 RICHARDSON, TEXAS 75080-3021
Phone: 972-883-2091 Fax: 972-883-2399

COMPUTER SCIENCE DEPARTMENT

ERIK JONSSON SCHOOL OF
ENGINEERING AND COMPUTER SCIENCE

October 20, 2026

Dear ONR Young Investigator Program Selection Committee:

I am pleased to provide my strongest endorsement for Dr. Xinya Du's application to the Office of Naval Research Young Investigator Program, entitled "Trustworthy Collective Reasoning and Evaluation for AI Agents." As an Assistant Professor in the Department of Computer Science at The University of Texas at Dallas, Dr. Du is an outstanding early-career researcher with exceptional potential to become a leader in artificial intelligence, with a focus on language model reasoning, evaluation, and autonomous agents. Our department is strongly committed to supporting his research and long-term academic career.

Dr. Du was recruited to UT Dallas based on his strong research accomplishments, technical expertise, and ambitious vision for advancing artificial intelligence. His recruitment reflects our department's commitment to attracting outstanding researchers with the potential to make significant contributions to their fields. Since joining the department, he has established an active research program addressing fundamental challenges in the reliability and reasoning capabilities of modern AI systems. His research has resulted in publications at leading conferences in natural language processing and machine learning, including NeurIPS, ACL and EMNLP. His ability to identify important emerging problems and develop original technical solutions distinguishes him as a highly promising young investigator.

Dr. Du's proposed ONR research, "Trustworthy Collective Reasoning and Evaluation for AI Agents," addresses a fundamental challenge in the development of reliable autonomous AI systems: enabling multiple agents to evaluate one another's reasoning, recognize relevant expertise, and improve collective decisions even when individual agents are imperfect or unreliable. The project seeks to develop novel methods for peer evaluation, collective reasoning, and trustworthy collaboration among AI agents. This research has significant potential to advance the foundations of multi-agent intelligence and contribute to reliable autonomous decision-making in complex environments. Dr. Du's expertise in language model reasoning and evaluation, together with his ongoing work on AI agents, positions him well to pursue this ambitious research agenda.

The University of Texas at Dallas is committed to providing sustained institutional support for Dr. Du's research and career development. The department has provided him with start-up funding, dedicated research space, and access to computing resources. We also support his research through a reduced teaching workload, support for graduate student recruitment, faculty mentoring, and professional development opportunities. These institutional investments will help Dr. Du further develop his independent research program and expand its impact. Our commitment extends beyond the proposed ONR award, reflecting our confidence in his long-term potential and our investment in his development as a leading faculty member.

Dr. Du exemplifies the qualities sought by the ONR Young Investigator Program: scientific creativity, technical excellence, research independence, and exceptional promise for sustained contributions to his

field. I strongly endorse his application and reaffirm our department's commitment to supporting his continued success at The University of Texas at Dallas.

Sincerely,

Rym Zalila-Wenkstern



Rym Zalila-Wenkstern, Ph.D.
Professor and Interim Department Head
Department of Computer Science
The University of Texas at Dallas
Email: rymw@utdallas.edu
Phone: (972) 883 2091